

Multi-Season Football Performance Intelligence

Executive Summary Report — Prepared for Club Stakeholders

Prepared by: Mwanahamisi Juma — Football Performance Analyst
mwanahamis050@gmail.com | +255 787 338 398

Project Overview

This project developed a data-driven performance intelligence framework to evaluate player and team trends across multiple seasons, using 1.8 million raw performance records refined to 88,375 players with sufficient multi-season history for reliable analysis. The work combined SQL for data structuring, Python for statistical validation (ANOVA, Tukey HSD, correlation, distribution analysis), and Tableau for visualization — producing findings that directly support recruitment, squad planning, and tactical decision-making.

88,375	79+	F = 6,414.5	r = 0.339
players analyzed	elite contribution threshold	positional difference (ANOVA)	key variable correlation

Key Findings

- Position is the strongest confirmed driver of output.** Forwards average 56.2 contributions vs. 29.3 for midfielders, 13.97 for defenders, and 0.24 for goalkeepers — statistically confirmed (ANOVA F = 6,414.5, p = 0; Tukey HSD significant across every positional pair).
- Elite performance is rare and concentrated, not evenly spread.** The distribution is heavily right-skewed (mean 28 vs. median 11, skewness 3.5) — a small group of elite players drives the overall average well above what a typical player achieves.
- Efficiency and consistency matter as much as career totals.** The highest per-90 efficiency in the dataset came from a player with a fraction of the minutes of the top cumulative scorers, and even elite players show wide swings between peak and low seasons.
- An objective elite threshold (79+ contributions) separates high performers from the wider population,** giving a consistent, data-driven benchmark for recruitment and squad evaluation.
- Club-level squad strategies differ sharply** — some clubs concentrate output in a small elite core, others spread it across a broad contributor base — both are viable models with different risk/cost trade-offs.

Business Impact

For the **Sporting Director**, this framework reduces recruitment and retention risk by replacing reputation-based judgment with multi-season, statistically grounded evidence of player value and sustainability. For the **Head Coach**, it supports position-specific squad selection, tactical planning, and early identification of player development or form issues. At the organizational level, it supports more efficient allocation of squad investment and a more sustainable, evidence-based approach to long-term competitive performance — including direct relevance to AFCON 2027 preparation, where standardized, position-adjusted metrics allow fair comparison of players across different leagues.

Priority Recommendations

For the Head Coach

- Adopt position-specific performance benchmarks instead of one blended KPI.
- Weight per-90 efficiency alongside total output in selection and rotation decisions.
- Track peak-vs-average form gaps to catch dips in performance early.

For the Sporting Director

- Use the 79+ elite threshold (position-adjusted) as a recruitment screening filter.
- Define a clear squad-building philosophy — concentrated elite talent vs. broad contributor depth — and align budget decisions to it.
- Require multi-season track records before high-value transfer commitments based on statistics alone.

Limitations

This analysis relies on publicly available data, which does not include tactical variables (xG, pressing, defensive actions, formations) or direct team-success measures (trophies, league position). Goal contribution favors attacking output and may undervalue defensive or tactical impact, and the elite threshold is calculated across all positions combined, naturally favoring forwards. These statistics are intended to support, not replace, scouting and coaching judgment.

Conclusion

Elite performance in this dataset is rare, concentrated, and multi-dimensional — driven far more by position, efficiency, and consistency than by career length or total minutes. This framework gives the club an objective, evidence-based foundation for recruitment, squad selection, and tactical planning, to be used alongside — not instead of — the football expertise already in the building.

Supporting Materials

The full technical write-up, SQL/Python methodology, and interactive Tableau dashboards referenced in this report are available in the accompanying project repository and Tableau Public workspace.

Mwanahamisi Juma
Football Performance Analyst